



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Frisco
School Website: <https://wwwFOUNDERSFRISCO.COM/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy - Frisco, TX presents a clearly classical framing in public-facing materials. The school emphasizes a classical education focused on virtue, truth, and beauty, and articulates goals around forming virtuous, knowledgeable citizens within a liberal-arts-inspired curriculum. Public materials stress partnership with families and a strong school-community orientation, including parent-led activities and enrollment processes that invite community involvement. However, while the language strongly signals classical aims (virtue, liberal arts, truth/beauty/goodness), several explicit classical criteria are not clearly evidenced in the site text (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language, detailed Socratic pedagogy, and the full array of Trivium/Quadrivium elements). On balance, the school exhibits a robust classical orientation, but with gaps relative to a full, canonical classical model.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle sections below identify concrete items that, if added or made explicit on the public site, would push the school toward CLASSICAL across the rubric.

- Concrete emphasis on Great Books and Great Conversation (explicitly naming canonical works or program structure around reading primary sources).
- Clear articulation of Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades, with evidence of recitation, narration, and rhetoric instruction (as distinct from general "classical approach" phrasing).
- Public, explicit statements about theology, liturgical/community practices, or sacramental/ liturgical elements (to strengthen Element 1's Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices).
- A more explicit portrait of the faculty as "living curriculum" and a teacher-mentored culture, with statements about teacher formation, collaborative collegiality, and teacher profiles.
- Stronger articulation of the full curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history integrated throughout the curriculum) beyond the general phrase "traditional liberal arts and sciences."
- Evidence and analysis drawn from available public materials and the classical education rubric, with keyword alignment to the Six Essential Elements.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize virtues and transcendent ideals, with phrases such as pursuing knowledge, promoting virtue, and oriented toward truth, beauty, and goodness. The school frames its mission around forming virtuous citizens in a free society and a classical educational ethos (e.g., “distinctively classical education that pursues knowledge, promotes virtue, and prepares students for prosperous lives in a free society”) and “an orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue (transcendentals/virtue). The lexicon documents these as positive indicators of classical formation. - Negative keywords: none evident in public text (no clear signals of relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral framing within the site text).

Why this rating - The site shows a transcendental moral realism through virtue and the true/beautiful/good ideals, but it does not overtly ground its program in theology or liturgical practices. Therefore, it demonstrates a strong but not fully theological/metaphysical foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit statements about formation and virtue, not merely job/work preparation: “the end (goal) of public education in America is to form responsible citizens and virtuous people who are prepared to flourish,” and “a distinctively classical education that pursues knowledge, promotes virtue, and prepares students for prosperous lives in a free society.” These lines map directly to formation, virtue, and human flourishing aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education (implicit), classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/good/beautiful. The classical-lexicon lists these as positive indicators; the site uses several of these terms directly.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue as central aims, aligning with the classical purpose criterion. Some advanced prompts (e.g., explicit “Great Conversation” or direct articulation of telos in a formal framework) are not fully spelled out, but the core aims are clearly classical.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site states a “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum” as a foundation of the program. This signals alignment with the liberal-arts framework characteristic of classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts (explicit), grammar, logic, rhetoric (mentioned as part of a liberal-arts framework in the lexicon as core elements; actual site text mentions liberal arts and sciences but not the four canonical Trivium components in explicit list). The lexicon identifies grammar, logic, rhetoric as core, and the site’s explicit phrase “traditional liberal arts and sciences curriculum” provides partial alignment.

Why this rating - The curriculum is described in broad liberal-arts terms, but not all canonical elements (e.g., explicit references to grammar, logic, rhetoric as a trio; Great Books; Great Conversation) are clearly spelled out on public pages. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a classical approach and a traditional curriculum, but there is limited explicit description of the pedagogy (e.g., no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, memory/narration,

chanting, or the classic “scholé” approach). The site does not clearly state restfulness/restful pedagogy nor the upper-school focus on Socratic dialogue, debates, or rhetoric practicum across grades as described by canonical classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: the site uses “classical approach,” “traditional liberal arts,” and “orientation towards truth, beauty, and goodness.” However, the explicit pedagogical techniques (narration, recitation, chanting, Socratic seminars) are not demonstrated in the site text. The Classical Lexicon lists many of these pedagogical elements as positives, but there is no explicit corroboration in the public-facing content.

Why this rating - The absence of concrete, named pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, *récitation*, etc.) on public pages leads to not meeting the full Pedagogy criteria, hence NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize the school’s mission and virtues and name the Headmaster, but there is no explicit language describing the faculty as the living curriculum, a portrait of teacher ideals, or a portrait of teacher-student collegial culture. The site otherwise highlights leadership and “distinctively classical education,” which is informative but not explicit about faculty as “living curriculum.”

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “virtue,” “pursues knowledge,” “distinctively classical education.” The lexicon notes that classical faculties are described as living curricula or portraits of teachers; such specifics are not present on the public pages.

Why this rating - While the school’s mission emphasizes virtue and classical aims, the public materials do not provide explicit signs of a faculty-as-living-curriculum, teacher-professional-formation, or a clearly-articulated teacher-portrait concept. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and fathers/mothers as co-educators through direct language such as partnering with you in the education of your scholar. There are explicit parent-related activities and events (PTO events, family nights, etc.) visible in the public materials. The site shows calendar items for family and school events (e.g., PTO dodgeball tournament; family nights; engagement through open enrollment). The school also uses “Open Enrollment” messaging, inviting community involvement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation (as referenced in the lexicon’s section), open campus/visits, seminars, book clubs (as described in the lexicon), and explicit parent events (PTO events, family nights). The lexicon lists these as positive signs of a classical parents-community component; the site shows multiple examples of parent engagement and community events.

Why this rating - The public materials strongly emphasize parental partnership, parent events, and a welcoming stance to families, aligning with the classical element of Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Add explicit Great Books and Great Conversation language and structure (e.g., naming canonical works, a “Great Books” sequence, or a program outline detailing how students engage with primary sources and participate in sustained conversations).

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- Provide explicit mention of Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, with examples of seminars, debates, and rhetorical training (including planned integration of recitation or narration in lower grades where applicable).
 - Publicly articulate more of the Trivium and Quadrivium components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and show how history is woven throughout the curriculum (not treated as separate “social studies” content but as part of Western civilization and primary-source study).
 - Strengthen Religious and Metaphysical Foundations through theology integration or liturgical/community practices (even in a secular framing, including well-defined, school-appropriate liturgical or ritual elements that align with a classical cadence).
 - Develop the “living curriculum” language for Faculty (explicit descriptions of teacher profiles, professional development in classical pedagogy, and teacher mentorship) to transform Faculty into a more clearly defined facet of classical formation.
 - Expand explicit Parent Formation offerings (book studies, lectures, and book clubs) that align with classical education philosophy and provide regular opportunities for parents to engage with Great Books and classical education concepts.
 - Strengthen a clearly defined historical continuum that demonstrates how the Great Books, memory work, and rhetoric are used as a scaffold from K-12, reinforcing the classical pedagogy across all grades.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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